

M-12 — Password Security & Multi-Factor Authentication

What is this about?

Why one reused password is the most likely way this company gets broken into.

The idea, in plain terms

Sanjay runs stores at a Nashik unit. Six years ago he used one password for a shopping site. He uses the same one at work. The shopping site was breached in 2021. Nobody told him, and the password still works here. Different passwords everywhere, remembered by a manager, not by you. In Multi-Factor Authentication: Ayesha handles HR records in Dubai. Her password leaked in a breach at a site she had forgotten about. Someone used it at 2am. They got the password right and still could not get in, because a code went to her phone.

Key things to know

- **THREE OR FOUR WORDS** — "copper-lantern-quiet-mango"
- **UNRELATED** — not your city, employer, family or team
- **LONG** — aim for sixteen characters or more
- **UNIQUE** — used on exactly one account, ever

A simple example

Situation: You get an alert that an old shopping site you used years ago was breached. You are fairly sure you used a similar password at work.

What to do: Change the work password today and report it.

Remember

- **Nobody guesses** — They use passwords that already leaked from other sites, tried automatically.
- **Reuse is the whole risk** — Your work account is as safe as the least careful site you ever joined.
- **Length beats symbols** — Four unrelated words beat eight clever characters, every time.
- **Small changes are not changes** — Adding a digit or swapping a letter is the first thing attackers try.
- **Let software remember** — One phrase you learn, and a unique password for everything else.

Inducto Learning & Knowledge — quick reference for M-12. Watch the lesson video for the full explanation; this page is a takeaway, not a replacement for it.